

Vertebral Column

→ Consist of 33 vertebrae and 23 intervertebral discs.

→ Vertebrae Column, divided into 5 regions

Cervical - 7

Thoracic - 12

Lumbar - 5

Sacral - 5 (fused)

Coccygeal - 4

→ Vertebrae ↑^s in size from Cervical to lumbar region and ↓^s in size from Sacral to Coccygeal region

→ fetus - One long curve, Convex posteriorly

→ Infants - Secondary Curve.

→ Adult - 4 distinct antero-posterior curve.

2 curves (Thoracic & Sacral) - posterior convexity are primary curves.

2 Curves (Cervical & lumbar) - posterior convexity are secondary curves.

→ Posterior convexity / Anterior Concavity - Kyphotic Curve.

→ Posterior Concavity / Anterior Convexity - Lordotic Curve.

Mobile Segment

→ Smallest functional unit in the spine is the mobile segment.

Typical Vertebra :-

→ Structure - 2 main parts.

— Anterior, cylindrically shaped vertebral body

• Posterior, irregularly shaped vertebral or Neural arch.

→ Vertebral body - wt bearing column for spine.

→ Neural arch

Pedicles

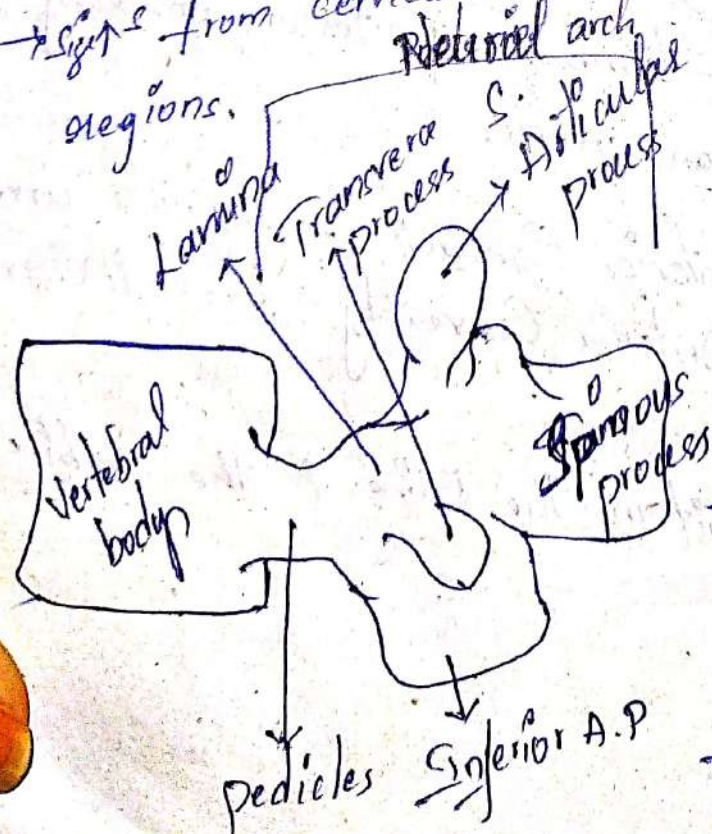
→ lies anterior to the articular processes on either side.

→ Function :

— transmit tension & bending forces from post. element to the vertebral bodies.

→ They are short, stout pillars with thick walls.

→ Size from cervical to lumbar regions.



Posterior element

→ Laminae, Articular processes, Spinous process, transverse processes.

→ Laminae : Centrally placed.

→ Laminae are thin, vertically oriented piece of bone that serve as "roof" to Neural arch, protects the spinal cord

→ Laminae transmit force from post. element to the pedicle, through them to vertebral body.

→ Force transfer occurs through a region of the laminae called Pars Interarticularis.
→ Present b/w the laminae and articular processes.

- Pars Interarticularis, that transmitted bending forces ~~that~~ transfer occurs from the vertically oriented lamina to horizontally oriented pedicles.
- They are more developed in lumbar region.

- Spinous processes & 2 transverse processes are sites for muscle attachment
- Articular processes consist of 2 superior and 2 inferior facets for articulation with facets from cranial & caudal vertebra

Inter vertebral Disc -

- Has 2 principle functions
to separate 2 vertebral bodies, thereby ring available motion & to transmit load from one vertebral body to next.

→ Make up about 20 to 33% of length of vertebral column, ↑ in size from cervical to lumbar region.

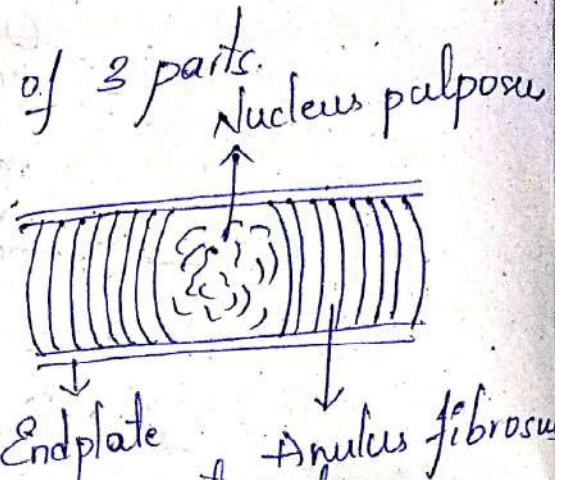
→ Disc thickness - Cervical : 3 mm (wt-bearing are lowest)
lumbar : 9 mm (wt-bearing are highest)

→ Disc are smallest in cervical & greatest/largest in lumbar region.

Ratio b/w disc thickness and vertebral body height.
→ Greater the ratio and Greater the mobility.

- Ratio is greater in cervical and lumbar, which produces greater mobility.
- Ratio is smallest in thoracic region, which produces with greater stability.
- Intervertebral disc composed of 3 parts.

- 1) Nucleus pulposus
- 2) Annulus fibrosus
- 3) Vertebral End plate

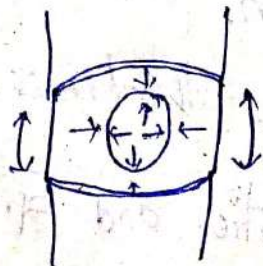
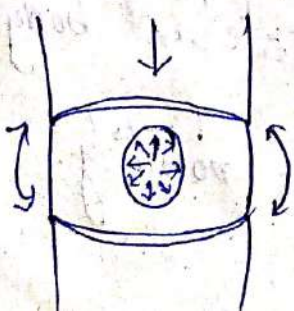


- Nucleus pulposus - Gelatinous mass at center.
- Annulus fibrosus - fibrous outer ring.
- Vertebral End plate - Cartilaginous layers covering the superior and inferior surface of disc.

Nucleus Pulposus -

- It consist of 70-90% of water by Age & time.
- 65% of Proteoglycans (PGs) - Holds water
- 15-20% of Collagen, Proteolytic enzymes, Chondroitin elastin fiber, proteins.

- Collagen → Type I → ↓ (distraction compression)
- Type II → ↑ (Retraction compression)



Annulus Fibrosus -

→ Water (60-70%), Collagen (50-60%), ↑ PGs
proteoglycans 20% dry wt, Elastin - 10% fibro-
blasts Chondroblasts.

Collagen

Type I

Type II

- Resists tensile forces

→ Superior and Inferior End plate.

End Plate -

→ Layer of cartilage superior / inferior surface (0.6-1 mm)
thick.

→ It has PGs, Water, Collagen.

→ Cartilage Cells

→ Hyaline

→ Fibrocartilage

Hyaline

Age

Fibrocartilage

↓

Near Nucleus.

↓
Near Vertebra

→ Fibrocartilage helps to take up load.

Innervation

- Intervertebral discs are innervated in the
Outer $\frac{1}{3}$ - $\frac{1}{2}$ of Annulus fibrosus branches of vertebral
and Sinuvertebral nerves.

↳ Also Innervates some Ligaments.

Nutrition -

Metaphyseal arteries from dense capillary plexus in base of end plate cartilage and sub-chondral bone - Also by diffusion.

Articulations -

- Two types of joint articulation
 - 1) Facet jt
 - 2) Inter body jt

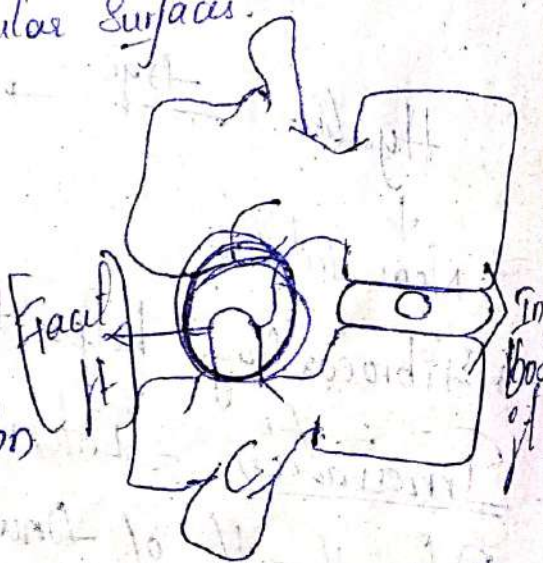
Facet jt

Also known as Syngophyseal Articulation and Diarthrodial joint.

- Intra-Articular accessory structure in several types
 - Adipose tissue pad
 - Fibroadipose Miniscoid
- Involved in protecting articular surfaces.

Inter body jt

- Side to side translation
- Superior Inferior translation
- Anterior & posterior translation
- Side to side Rotation
- Superior & ~~Posterior~~ Inferior (Rotation in transverse plane)
- Anterior posterior Rotation.



Ligaments

Anterior Longitudinal Ligament :-

→ Starts from Sacrum to C_2 [C_2 - Occiput]

Called as Anterior Atlanto-Occipital.

Anterior Atlanto-Axial

→ 2 layers

Superficial - Long, covers several vertebra

Deep - Short, - covers single vertebra.

- Blends with Annulus fibrosus

- Reinforces Antero-lateral portion of Disc/Body.

Well developed in (cervical, lumbar)

→ ↑↑ tensile strength at cervical - 2x than posterior longitudinal ligament.

→ Compressed in flexion

Stretched in extension

Lax in neutral.

Posterior Longitudinal Ligament :-

→ From Sacrum to C_2 [C_2 - Occiput]

Called as Tectorial membrane.

→ 2 layers

Superficial - Long, covers many vertebra

Deep - Fibers extend to adjacent vertebra.

- Outer layer of Annulus and end plate margin.

→ Lumbar region ligament is narrow - No proper support for disc → High incidence of herniation in posterio-lateral direction.

Ligamentum Flavum :-

→ Lamina ↔ Lamina (Thick, elastic).

C₂ - Sacrum.

→ Smooth posterior surface of canal.

C₂ to Occiput - posterior Atlanto occipital

Atlanto axial membrane

→ Creates compressive force on disc

Stiff disc - Better support will not buckle on itself (Elastic)

Inter Transverse Ligament :-

→ Extremely variable.

→ Pass b/w transverse process and attach to deep muscles (Stretch - compress) - with lateral flexion.

Interspinous Ligament :-

→ Connects the spinous process of adjacent vertebrae.

→ 1st one to damage with excessive flexion.

Contribute to lumbar spine stability and degenerative aging (Collagen type I, Pbs, Elastin).

Supraspinous Ligament :-

→ Strong, cordlike, Connects spinous process
[C7 - L3-4]

→ Merge with Thoraco-lumbar Fascia.

Cervical region - Ligamentum Nuchae

→ 1st one to damage with excessive flexion

They have mechanoreceptors that affect
Multifidus → Recruitment of Spinal stabilizers.

Kinematics :-

→ Movement occurs in interbody jt and zygapophyseal jt.

→ Movements → Flexion
Extension
Lateral flexion
Rotation

→ Coupling movements occurs in Lateral flexion
+ Rotation.

→ What affects the motion orientation of Articulating
facet.

Elasticity, Fluidity, Thickness of disc.

Extensibility of Muscle

Extensibility of Capsule

Extensibility of Ligament

Facet

→ Direction decided by orientation of facet.
Changes in every region.

Sagittal plane - Flexion, Extension [Lumbar region]
Frontal plane - Lateral flexion [Thoracic region]
Transverse plane - Rotation [Cervical region]

Disc

→ Amount of motion determined by size.
Nucleus acts like a pivot with lot of fluid.

Flexion

→ Anterior tilt + Glide of the spine (Anterior glide)
→ Flexion + extension is more pre-dominant in lumbar region with sagittal plane.
→ Size ↑ in intervertebral foramen.
→ Anterior anulus compressed.
→ Resistance for flexion by Spinous process, Ligament, Capsule, Ligamentum flavum, posterior anulus, posterior longitudinal ligament.

Extension

→ Posterior tilt + posterior glide
→ Size ↓ in intervertebral foramen
→ Posterior anulus compressed.
→ Resistance - Spinous process.
→ Anterior trunk muscles, Anterior longitudinal ligament → Only ligament that resists

extension, that's y thick and strong.

Rotation

→ Depends highly on facet and varies from region to region.

Lateral flexion

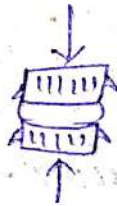
→ Lateral tilt + Rotation + Translation

→ Inter vertebral foramen $\uparrow$ in opposite side
 $\downarrow$ in same side.

→ Annulus compresses on the same side and stretches on opposite side.

Kinetics :-

Axial Compression.



→ Gravity, GRF, Muscles and Ligaments

→ In vertebral body [25-55%] load is taken up by cancellous bone before 40 yrs, After 40 yrs cortical bone takes higher loads.

→ Zygapophyseal joint [0-33%] depending on posture & region.

→ Nucleus pulposus exhibits swelling pressure outward
Countered by annulus and end plate (Equilibrium).

→ Disc exhibits creep with loading and diurnal changes.

Shear force

Cervical Spine :-

→ divided into 2 region

Upper Cervical Region [Craniovertebral]

Lower Cervical Region.

→ They are 2 types of Vertebrae

Typical Vertebrae

Atypical Vertebrae

C₁ - Atlas

C₂ - Axis

C₇ - Transition Vertebra

where the cervical spine turns into
thoracic spine.

Atypical Vertebra

Atlas - C₁

→ Function - Cradles occiput and transfers forces to the
lower cervical vertebra.

→ No body, 2 large facets

Foramen for vertebral artery

Superior Articulating Surface - Large, Concave

Inferior Articulating Surface - Slightly Convex

Gout on internal surface → for Dens.

Axis - C₂

→ Transmit force, provides axial rotation dens has

Superior facet which articulates with anterior arch of Atlas Superior facet faces upward, Laterally

Inferior facet faces Anteriorly.

→ Spinous process has a bifid (2 part)

Articulation

Atlanto-Occipital (2) jts

→ Concave Superior facet (Atlas) and Convex Condyles of occiput.

→ True Synovial jt, Almost in horizontal plane.

→ It have interarticular meniscoid and fibro adipose structure.

Atlanto-Axial Jt (3)

→ Median Atlanto axial jt [Synovial trochoid (pivot)]

B/w Dens and Atlas.

→ Lateral jts b/w Superior facet of axis and inferior facet of atlas - Biconvex

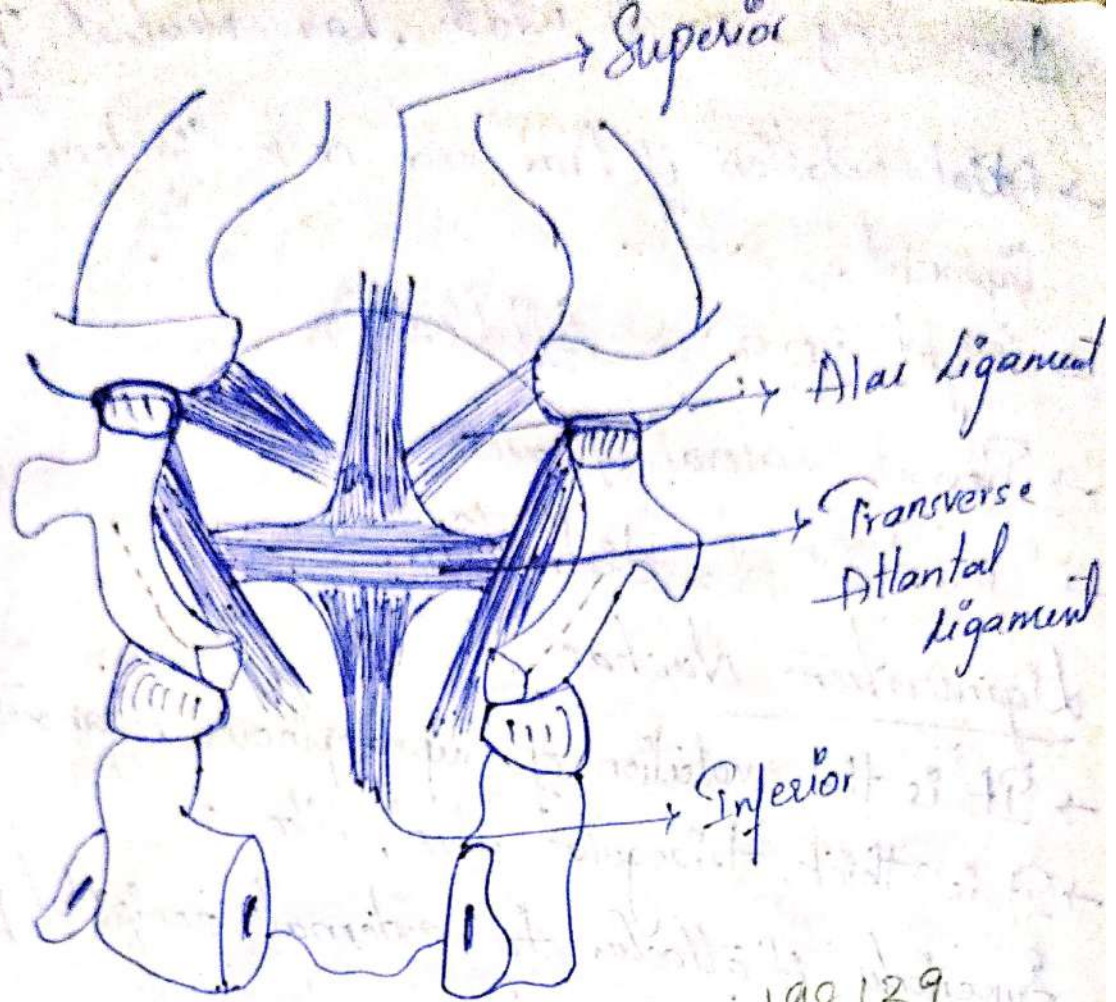
→ Axis rotates B/w osteoligamentous ring formed by anterior arch and transverse ligament.

Ligaments

Transverse Atlantal Ligament

→ Across ring of atlas → posterior (spinal cord)

↳ Anterior (dens)



- Anterior Surface has cartilage
- Superior long ligament → Occiput
- Inferior fibers → posterior to Axis

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Atlantal Cruciform Ligament

- Articular surface holds Dens prevents anterior displacement of C_1 on C_2 [Stability]
- Superior and inferior parts assist
- Very strong - dens break before Ligament

Alar Ligament

- Paired Ligament - from either side of dens → Occiput Condyles
- Atlas laterally

1cm long, pencil width, Lat - Neutral, Taut-
Flexion.

→ Axial rotation of head and neck tightens the alar ligament.

→ Right (upper) Left (lower)

→ Prevent lateral flexion.

→ Prevents C₁-C₂ distraction.

Ligamentum Nuchae

→ It is the evolution of Supraspinous ligament.

→ It is thick, triangular, sheet, like

Superiorly it attaches to external occipital protuberance and foramen magnum.

Inferiorly - Tip of 7 Spinous process.

→ They are 2 parts

Dorsal Raphae

Ventral

→ Dorsal Raphae - Narrow strips of collagenous tissue interlacing tendons of upper traps Splenius capitis and Rhomboid minor muscle.

→ Ventral midline Septum runs ventrally on dorsal raphae, Continuous with inter spinous lig (A-A) membrane, fascia of Semi spinalis capitis, Splenius capitis.

→ Attached to vertebra and is capable of R flexion.

Longitudinal Ligament

→ Ligamentum flavum - posterior Atlanto-occipital and atlanto-axial membrane.

→ Less elastic, ↑ ROM (Rotation)

→ Anterior Atlanto-Occipital and Atlanto-Axial membrane.

→ Tectorial membrane continues as posterior longitudinal ligament.

↳ Broad strong membrane originates from posterior vertebral body of axis, covers dens & cruciate ligament and inserts at

Lower Cervical Region

Typical Vertebra - Body

→ It is small and transverse diameter is high than antero-posterior diameter.

→ Uncinate process -

After the body there is the upward curve which makes the concave shape in the frontal plane is made by this uncinate process.

Arch

Pedicle - After the body postero-laterally.

Lamina - Posteriorly but medially.

→ They are thin and slightly curved.

Facet

Superior facet - Oval shaped and supero posterior.

Inferior facet - Infero anterior.

→ Facet size ↑ as you go down from C₃ → C₇

Transverse Process

Foramen - Vertebral artery, vein, venous plexus passes.

Spinous Process

→ It is short, slender, bifid tip.

Disc

Annular fibers - Crescent shape

- It is thick anteriorly

taper laterally

posteriorly only with posterior longitudinal ligament

Joints of Luschka

Also known as Uncovertebral joints.

→ Fissures in disc develop along with the

Uncinate process.

↓
These clefts become joint.

Kinematics

Upper Cervical Spine

Atlanto-Occipital Joint

→ Nodding movement.

Flexion - Condylus rolls forward and slide backward.

Extension - Condylus rolls backward and slide forward.

→ Few degree of rotation and lateral flexion, they are resisted as Condylus rise up from Atlantal Socket.

Atlanto-Axial joint

- All movement ↓ but main movement rotation ↑.
- Atlas pivots around dens to 45° both sides.
- Alar ligament limits the motion (Resistated).
- Lateral flexion coupled with contralateral rotation.

Lower Cervical Spine

→ Movement depends on shape and orientation of the facet.

→ Flexion - Anterior tilt + Anterior translation.

- Extension - Posterior tilt + Posterior translation.
- Lateral flexion Coupled with ipsilateral rotation.
- ROM :- Flexion-Extension $\uparrow C_2/C_3 \rightarrow C_5/C_6$

Joint capsule is lax ($\uparrow$ ROM in young)

Disc Height > Disc width $\rightarrow \uparrow$ ROM

Disc ($C_5 - C_6$) - $\uparrow$ Stress

Kinetics

- Cervical region bears less weight but it is more mobile.

Upper Cervical Spine (No disc).

- Force transferred through facet, lamina and arches.
- Lamina of axis and C_7 are heavily loaded with trabeculae $\rightarrow$ absorption of force.

Lower Cervical Spine

3 - Columns - 1 Anterior central
 - $\frac{2}{3}$ force (vertebral body + Disc)

- 2 Posterior laterally
 - $\frac{1}{2}$ force (Facet)

- Compressive force $\uparrow \uparrow$ (Flexion + extension).

→ Extension - Resisted by facet block and intervertebral disc.

→ Flexion - Resisted by posterior longitudinal ligament and spinous ligaments.

Muscles

Posterior - Trapezius, levator Scapulae, deep muscles

Lateral - Scalenes, Sternocleidomastoid

Anterior - Rectus Group.

Thoracic Spine

Articulation

Intervertebral joint

→ Flat vertebral surface allows all translation disc between allows tipping

→ Cervical region

Saddle type joint Concave + Convex
↓
Due to uncinate process.

Facet joint

→ Plane synovial jts.

Fibro adipose meniscoid tissue

→ ↑ lateral flexion, Rotation ↓ Flex - Extension

Capsule around it more taut than cervical.

Ligaments

- Ligamentum flavum and anterior longitudinal
- Ligaments are thicker in thoracic Region.

Body

- Antero-posterior = Transverse diameter [equal]

↓
Gives stability.

- Wedge shaped → produces kyphosis
- Costocapitular demifacet.

Facet

- Frontal plane orientation.

Transition at $T_{10} - T_{11}$

- Superior facet - posteriorly, Superiorly, Laterally

Inferior facet - Anteriorly, Inferiorly, Medially.

- Transition to sagittal plane slowly Superior →

Superiorly - Anteriorly to Posterolaterally

Inferiorly - Anteromedially.

Transverse Process and Disc

- Thick ends - Costotubercular articulation with

ribs [oral facet]

- Disc are thin - ↑ stability ↓ mobility

→ Wedge-shaped - kyphosis - 1° stabilizer

Disc Spinous Process

→ slope inferior from T₅ - T₈

T₁₁ - T₁₂ - triangular

- Horizontal

Kinematics

→ Upper Thoracic Region [T₁ - T₆]

→ Flexion - Extension limited due to rigid rib cage,

ligament facet orientation.

→ ↑ lateral flexion + Rotation → Coupled movement

of rotation + lateral flexion - Same side

→ lateral flexion and rotation limited by rib cage

Lower Thoracic Region [T₉ - T₁₂]

→ ↓ Rotation and ↑ flexion - Extension - facet in
Sagittal plane.

→ Coupled movement of Rotation + lateral flexion
(opp side)

→ Ribs on ipsilateral side of rotation ↑ Convexity

Rotation ROM depends on Ribs flexibility, ROM
at [Costo vertebral]

Kinetics

→ ↑ Compressive forces

Kyphotic, upper limb

→ Line of gravity - Anterior

↳ Flexion moment (thoracic spine)

Counteracted by posterior longitudinal ligament and spinal extensors.

Lumbar Spine

Body:

→ Transverse diameter > Anterior posterior diameter > height

↑ Size.

Archus:

→ Pedicle are short, thick.

→ Lamina is short & broad.

Foramen: - Triangular large

Spinous process: - Broad, thick, horizontal.

Facet

Facet vary in both shape and orientation - Sagittal

→ Mamillary process - Multifidus and medial inter transverse (attachment)

→ Curved surface, Biplanar

Anterior - frontal plane

Posterior - Sagittal plane

↑ flexion - Extension

↓ Rotation

Disc

→ Lamella - has Concentric rings.

120° of opposite direction.

→ Helps in resist tensile force in all directions.

→ Largest disc.

Elliptical + Concave (Posterior)

Thoracic are convex (Posterior)

Ligaments

→ Supraspinous lig - till L_{3/4}

↳ Deep fiber reinforced by Multifidus.

→ Intra-Transverse lig - Not a true ligament

↳ It replaced by ilio-lumbar ligament at L₅.

→ Posterior Longitudinal lig - Thin.

→ Ligamentum flavum - Thick

→ Anterior Longitudinal lig - Thick, Strong, well developed.

Iliolumbar ligaments

Anterior

- L₅ transverse process of iliac Crest.

Posterior

- L₅ transverse process of iliac Crest (posteriorly)

Sacral Band / lumbosacral ligament

- Transverse process of L₅ → Ala of Sacrum and anterior sacro-iliac ligament

Stabilizes (L₅)

- Resist all movements of L₅ to S₁ (anterior displacement)
- This lig maximally loaded in lumbo-sacral junction in absence of muscle protection
- Slouch sitting → Creep → Injury → lower back pain.

Thoracolumbar Fascia

Anterior (Passive)

- Arise from Quadratus lumborum, Joins the middle layer and inserts into inter-transverse ligament.

- Through transverse process of lumbar spine.

Function:

Transmits tension to spinous process by Contralateral hip extension.

Posterior (Active layer)

- Large, thick, fibrous, arise from spinous process
- Travels laterally over erector spinae → Lateral Raphe
- Internal oblique, transverse abdominus, arise from Lateral Raphe.
- Goes back to transverse process.

Middle

- Both the layers are surround the lumbar extensor group.

Uses

- ↑ Spinal stiffness.
- Stabilizing Corset → Hoop around abdominus
- ~~activation~~ Transverse abdominus activation → stiff fascia
- Mechanical transmission through (Gluteus and latissimus dorsi) → B/w trunk and pelvis.

Kinematics

Lumbopelvic Rhythm

- lumbar flexion + Anterior pelvic tilt

① Lumbosacral flexion

② Anterior pelvic tilt at hip joint

→ Bending down.

- Vice - versa while coming up.
- Hip motion ↑ ROM, ↓ flexibility required.
- Prevents excessive lengthening of annulus and posterior ligament [protective function].

Vertebral Motion

- Flexion → Anterior tilt + Anterior glide.
- Extension → Posterior tilt + Posterior glide.
- Disc will compress anteriorly - Nucleus will move posteriorly.
- In extension vice - versa.
- ↳ Inter vertebral space ↓
- ↑ (flexion - extension) at lumbo sacral region
- ↑ lateral flexion - Rotation - Upper lumbar region and starts reducing in lower lumbar region.

Kinetics

- Compression - 80%
- Primary function of lumbar region is to provide support to upper body (static + Dynamic).
- Tremendous compressive force ← muscle contraction
- Compressive / Shear forces can change with Lordosis.

→ Compressive load on facet
Degeneration of Disc

Shear force - 20%

→ Present in upright position.

Anterior shear force - Lordosis

Resist by inferior facet of Superior vertebra

Over Superior facet of inferior vertebra.

→ Facet orientation → Big roll.

→ If facet is in sagittal plane. The capsule and

ligament will be stretched ← Creep.

→ Some compressive forces on facet even if its

biplanar → Pain, Erector spinae provide

dynamism restrain to → Anterior Shear.

Sacral Region

Structure

Sacral Articulation

→ Ear shaped, laterally ($S_1 - S_3$)

→ Surface is multiplanar, Curvy covered with hyaline

Cartilage.

1-3 mm thickness > Iliac cartilage.

Articulation of Iliia

- Hyaline Cartilage (↑ density) (In thickness)
- Surface is Curvy, multiplanar posteriorly and superiorly
- Tuberosity articulates with Sacral tuberosity via Sacro-iliac interosseous ligament.
- Tuberosity - Irregular, Bony surface (posterior) to articular surface [Syndesmosis].

Stability

- SI jt relieves stress on pelvis and allows force to move through lumbar region.

Mobility

- Allow movement to absorb the twisting forces from lower limb.

Sacroiliac ligaments

- They are 3 parts
 - 1) Anterior / capsular ligament
 - 2) Interosseous - major SI jt link b/w tuberosities
 - 3) Posterior → strength & stability
 - ↳ long posterior SI ligament.
- Re-inforced by Quadratus lumborum, Erector spinae, Iliacus piriformis, Glut. max, minimus

Ilivolumbar Ligaments

→ Anterior, posterior, sacral band. Attaches from lumbar vertebra → Ilium

Sacrospinous Ligament

→ Ischial spine → Sacrum, Coccyx forms the inferior border of great Sciatic Notch.

Sacroteruberous Ligament

→ Ischial tuberosity → Sacrum, Coccyx; inferior border of lesser Sciatic notch.

Symphysis Pubis

Superior pubic ligament - Very thick, dense, and supports the superior aspect.

Inferior pubic ligament - Present on the inferior aspect of the pubic and Ramus.

Posterior Pubic Ligament - Articulation reinforced by Rectus abdominus, transverse Abdominus, adductor long, Oblique.